

Microsoft Azure

Microsoft Azure is the cloud platform created by Microsoft and ranked by Gartner as an industry leader for both IaaS and PaaS. Azure supports Linux, Windows, Oracle, SQL Server, C# and Java.

Developer(s): Microsoft

Initial release: 2010

Licence: Closed source for the platform, open source for client SDKs

Website: <http://azure.microsoft.com/en-in/>

Supported technologies: SQL Database, BLOB storage, Redis cache, HDInsight Hadoop, GIT, Eclipse

Features:

- 99.95 per cent compute SLA
- Built-in network load-balancing, software patching and high-availability features
- 24x7 technical support
- Identity and access management for all applications
- Managed SQL and NoSQL data services

Offerings and pricing: Purchase options such as pay-as-you-go subscriptions, enterprise agreements, Microsoft Resellers, etc. More details are available at <http://azure.microsoft.com/en-in/pricing/>

Free trial: Available

IBM Bluemix

IBM Bluemix is an open-standards cloud PaaS developed by IBM to build, run and manage applications. It provides a good choice of DevOps tooling.

Developer(s): IBM

Initial release: 2014

Written in: Python, Java, PHP

Licence: Proprietary

Website: <http://www.ibm.com/cloud-computing/bluemix/>

Supported technologies: Node.js, GO, Ruby Sinatra, Ruby on Rails, Scala

Features:

- Application-centric runtime environments based on Cloud Foundry
- Portable and consistent delivery of applications by using Docker
- Support for deployment and management of hybrid applications
- NoSQL JSON database platform for Web and mobile workloads
- Access to IoT devices and data

Offerings and pricing: Pricing options for runtimes, Watson, mobile, DevOps, Web and application, integration, data management, Big Data, security, business analytics, Internet of Things, and support at <https://console.ng.bluemix.net/pricing/>

Free trial: Available

AWS Elastic Beanstalk

AWS Elastic Beanstalk is used to deploy and scale applications developed in different languages on servers such as Passenger, Apache, Nginx, IIS, etc.

Developer(s): Amazon Web Services

Initial release: 2011

Licence: Proprietary

Website: <http://aws.amazon.com/documentation/elastic-beanstalk/>

Supported technologies: Git, Java Web application archive, Ruby, PHP, Python, .NET framework, Docker, Node.js

Features:

- Eclipse and Visual Studio IDE to deploy Web applications to AWS Elastic Beanstalk
- Support to multiple versions of an application
- Amazon Linux AMI and the Windows Server 2008 R2 AMI are used to run AWS Elastic Beanstalk
- Amazon CloudWatch monitoring
- Access to log files

Offerings and pricing: No additional charge for AWS Elastic Beanstalk. Users only pay for AWS resources such as EC2 instances or S3 buckets

Free trial: Available

To increase developers' productivity and innovation, organisations need to select PaaS solutions that are flexible, multi-tenant, based on standards, and provide support to multiple platforms or technologies. PaaS and DevOps practices go hand in hand nowadays, and hence the organisation's culture plays an important role in selecting a PaaS solution.

References

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Note: Details regarding PaaS solutions providers have been taken from the Internet.



By: Mitesh Soni

The author is a technical lead. He loves to write about new technologies and the cloud. Blog: <http://clean-clouds.com>